Zahed Heidari

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Details

Stoke-on-Trent, UK
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Links

LinkedIn
GitHub
Sessionize

Skills

Languages

TypeScript, JavaScript, PHP, .NET, HTML, CSS

Frameworks

React Native, React, Next.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Zod

AI

Claude Code, Codex, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, agentic workflows, context and prompt engineering

Tooling

GitHub, Jest, Nx, Storybook, Firebase, Vercel, Figma, Jira, Agile

Speaking

Developers Now Have a Second Brain: Learning to Think With AI

agentic codingCon, Berlin
`next.app devCon · ~200 people`
`Oct 2026`

Practically AI
`May 2026`

Macc Tech
`Apr 2026`

Education

BSc Computer Science
First Class Honours
Staffordshire University
`2019 – 2022`

Summary

Senior Software Engineer building web and mobile products, and the AI that runs inside them.

- Core maintainer of SMARTY's React Native app, used by **over a million people**
- Champion my team's AI adoption: the **usage standard** and the guardrails for running agents
- Conference speaker: gave a talk to around 200 people at **agentic codingCon, Berlin**

Experience

Senior Developer · Blue Beck Ltd

`Jul 2026 – Present`

Promoted to steer the standards on SMARTY's app and how the team works with AI.

- Champion the team's AI adoption: run the Claude team subscription, wrote the **AI usage standard**, and set the guardrails that let developers run agents in auto mode.
- One of three core maintainers of SMARTY's React Native app, owning code quality standards and architectural decisions across a **1M+ user** ecosystem.
- Maintain the team's shared context library, so every developer's AI tools work from the same standards and project knowledge.
- Present technical updates and strategy to SMARTY stakeholders, translating engineering decisions for non-technical audiences.
- Drive the removal of legacy code and the modernisation of development standards.

Developer · Blue Beck Ltd

`Mar 2023 – Jul 2026`

Joined SMARTY's React Native team as its most junior developer and grew into one of its core maintainers.

- Part of the team that **rewrote the app from the ground up**, integrating its group functionality.
- Reviewed, tested and blocked unstable code to protect long-term project health.
- Presented progress in large client meetings and worked with clients directly on requirements, alongside QA and PMs in Agile delivery.

Senior Web Solutions Developer · Interlockdigital

`Jul 2022 – Mar 2023`

Rebuilt Curtains Made's made-to-measure storefront and the stock tooling behind it.

- Built a programmatic bridge from the client's stock system to **Oracle NetSuite**, with a scheduler syncing stock data and images.
- Built a VB.NET stock management interface and XSLT-driven post-order emails for customers and suppliers.
- Built a WordPress plugin syncing with a third-party API in real time, and maintained the client apps in production.

Junior Web Solutions Developer · Interlockdigital

May 2020 – Jul 2022

First role in industry, alongside a computer science degree.

- Co-built the **Warmshowers** React Native app with one other developer, published on both stores for a 150,000+ member community; it brings in over £50,000 a year.
- Led the truck audit app in **Michelin**'s move off the legacy Alloy framework to React Native, and supported the costings app.
- Built **RedFred**, a WordPress plugin producing 100 bespoke PDFs in under 15 minutes, replacing weeks of manual design.

Personal Projects

Client work is listed under Experience.

Markscheme

Jul 2026 – Present

A benchmark for how often a model invents a spec the source never stated.

- Tests how reliably language models pull structured specifications out of real model-release announcements, scored against a hand-written answer key.
- Running a model and scoring it are kept apart, so a change to the scoring rules re-scores every past run without paying for new calls.
- Every prompt is versioned and recorded with each run, so a score can always be traced to the exact prompt behind it.
- A response that fails validation is recorded as a failure, never quietly turned into an empty answer.

Context Hub

May 2026 – Present

One set of engineering rules, mounted into every repository so agents inherit it.

- Every AI coding tool reads it through the entry files it already looks for, so each one starts a task from the same standards.
- Every fact has exactly one home and is referenced by name everywhere else, which stops a rule drifting into contradictory copies.
- Changes through use: recurring friction in any project becomes a change to the standard, and a monthly sweep catches rules that have gone stale.

Portfolio Website · zahedheidari.co.uk

Jan 2025 – Mar 2026

Designed in Figma and built from scratch on Next.js and TypeScript.

- Designed entirely in Figma: wireframes, interactive prototypes, brand colours, typography and a reusable component library, all before a line of code was written.
- Draws its own GitHub contribution calendar from the GitHub API, and opens on a Three.js rocket drawn live in the browser.
- Hand-built at first; later work is done alongside AI agents, to an engineering standard of my own.

Framer Portfolio Template

Mar 2026 – Present

A portfolio built in Framer, shaped as a template to deploy again for the next person.

- Fonts, colours and content are the parts that change for each person; the layout, components and type scale carry over.
- A CMS holds every important collection, and custom React code fills the gaps the built-in elements leave.